

As Amelio manned the reins at Apple, Microsoft released 'Windows 95'. Apple had been developing an evolved version of the Mac OS – Mac OS 8, codenamed 'Copland'. But, because it failed to meet its deadline and a year had passed since the release of Windows 95, Amelio decided to look for a new OS. These events would bring Steve Jobs back into the ranks of the company he created.

The return of the king

After Steve Jobs left Apple in 1985, he did two very significant things. He acquired The Graphics Group from Lucasfilm to create Pixar and he founded NeXT in 1985.

NeXT was a computer company aimed at the education industry. Inspired by his meeting with Nobel laureate Paul Berg, Jobs and a few other employees who were also let go off from Apple began drawing up plans for a machine powerful enough to simulate lab tests, yet cheap enough for college students to afford.



Job's company NeXT created cheap and powerful desktops for students.

By mid '86, NeXT would also begin developing operating systems and by '87, NeXT's factory at Fremont, California began rolling out the NeXT Computer running the NeXTStep OS. By 1996, despite some pretty nifty machines, NeXT decided to stop manufacturing hardware and switched focus to software. When word that Apple was looking for a new OS reached Jobs, he ensured that NeXTStep would be picked over BeOS.

As part of the deal, Apple would acquire NeXT for over \$400 million. The events that would lead to Apple's comeback at Jobs' hands were beginning to transpire. In 1997, Jobs was appointed as a consultant and NeXTStep was developed as the basis for the next version of the Mac OS.

The comeback king

By July, the quarterly results were out and the \$30 million profits Amelio had brought were flipped upside down. Amelio was asked to step down by the board of directors and Jobs was brought on as the interim CEO. He